

ART IS FOREVER
MARIGNY, NOLA



WALK-INS AND
APPOINTMENTS

Hi again,

So a lot has happened since we last spoke. I've been hard at work tracking the violet absinthe they found in Celestine's system and doing everything I can to figure out who won the absinthe at the Three Kings Ball. Since it was one of the biggest events of the season, I was there that night along with Celestine and Ines, and the rest of our suspects were there too.

Just to give you some context, the Three Kings is like a super-ball. On the first day of the Carnival season, a bunch of krewes stop competing and actually come together to raise money for NOLA KidsArt, the org Celestine founded, by auctioning off various cool antiques from Carnival history. It sounds nerdy, but we all love it.

So, Celestine, Ines, and I went to support the foundation and just have a good time. It was about six weeks before Cel was murdered, and I guess it was kind of the swan song for the Bywater Babes. I vaguely remember some weird things and bad energy happening all around us, but I was too busy enjoying the party to really pay attention. I guess that's just another reason why I'm trying to figure out what happened in hindsight.

Lucky for us, I did get in contact with Celestine's little cousin I was telling you about. His name's Elijah, and he really is sweet. Every mother's dream, if you know the type. Always polite, calls me ma'am, holds his grandma's purse on the way to church... Although I do think he's been trying to shake up his wholesome image lately. He comes by Ink Your Bones at least once every few weeks to get a tattoo from me, usually something to do with whatever manga he's into at the moment, but I keep telling him he's too young to get one without parent permission.

Fortunately, his studious side came in handy for us, because he made some very detailed notes about what went on that night. (Celestine let him be her "intern" for the event so that he could put it on his college applications.) He's re-organized them on some of the documents for us, a flyer and a comic book that got passed out as a Three Kings souvenir, so keep an eye out for those. He also gave us a spoon from the auction that someone left behind. I'm sending it as a thank you for all your hard work so far.

I'm hoping we can use his notes to piece together who bought the bottle of the violet absinthe, our link to the killer. I can just picture each of our suspects coming up to Celestine in the graveyard and holding out the bottle. "Oh you're here too? Let's have a drink, Cel. It's all water under the bridge." Every time I think about it, my blood boils.

And speaking of things that upset me, when I stopped by the MKML den the other night, Ines was talking about the krewe's post-Celestine future, again assuming she'd be elected captain. Eventually, she went outside for a smoke and left her phone just sitting on the table. Thankfully, she never locks her phone, and I couldn't help myself so I just started digging.

I found a text between her and Celestine on the night of the murder that you should really take a look at. I think about what happened between the two of them that night, and then I think about the three of us at the Three Kings Ball, and it all seems so wrong. When we were all laughing and having a good time, I could have never imagined that in a few weeks, one of us would be dead, and another a suspect. I still can't believe it. These were my best friends. So much for the Bywater Babes, right?

I put the text on the shared desktop at royalstreetcase.com along with a link to the Three Kings Ball website. The password for the desktop is now SAZERAC.

I'm really counting on you to help me piece the events of that night together, especially since we're getting so close. Just send me an email with the subject WINNER, and in the email, give me the name of who won the violet absinthe. Then we'll move on from there.

Best of luck, and I hope to hear from you soon.

Sylvia Jones